NewsBank inc.

Nation's Leading Gun Safety Organizations Applaud Creation of 'Legislators for Safer Communities'

September 17, 2024 | Targeted News Service (USA)
Section: Public Policy Groups | 855 Words
OpenURL Link

WASHINGTON, Sept. 17 -- The Brady Campaign to Prevent Gun Violence issued the following news release:

* * *

Legislators for Safer Communities is Comprised of 171 Lawmakers Representing 43 States Across the Country, All Committed to Reducing Gun Violence

* * *

Today, five of the nation's leading gun violence prevention organizations, Brady, Community Justice, Everytown for Gun Safety, GIFFORDS, and March For Our Lives, issued the following statements applauding the launch of Legislators for Safer Communities, an independent, nonpartisan coalition of 171 state legislators, representing 43 states across the country, committed to reducing gun violence.

Legislators for Safer Communities is led by six co-chairs and 22 steering committee members who are champions of gun violence prevention in their states. The slate of leaders embodies a representative and geographically diverse group who have varied experiences surrounding gun violence, including many of whom are survivors and who represent communities disproportionately impacted by gun violence.

"When Congress is gridlocked, we have watched state legislators across the country who understand that gun violence is preventable, work relentlessly in their statehouses to keep their communities safe from gun violence," said Tanya Schardt, Senior Counsel and Senior Director of State and Federal Policy at Brady. "Now, with the formation of this new coalition, their efforts have been united as they pursue their shared goals: to save lives through common sense and evidence-based policies. Brady applauds these champions and supports their efforts."

"Gun violence in America is not inevitable, and when lawmakers pass common sense gun safety laws, the research is clear: lives are saved," said Monisha Henley, senior vice president for government affairs at Everytown for Gun Safety. "State lawmakers are on the frontlines of combatting our gun violence epidemic and by launching this coalition, legislators from across the country will work together to turn the tide on this preventable crisis. We applaud the leaders who have joined forces to advocate for the safety of our communities and call on other lawmakers to join in the fight."

"Since the mass shooting at Sandy Hook Elementary School, more than 600 gun safety bills have been passed in nearly every state. Progress has been possible and lives have been saved because of brave lawmakers who have stood up for what is right. GIFFORDS is proud to support Legislators for Safer Communities in the fight to end gun violence," said Sean Holihan, State Legislative Director, GIFFORDS.

"All politics is local, and that couldn't be more true when it comes to combating gun violence and protecting young people's lives," said Madelyn Cobb, Policy and Government Affairs Manager at March For Our Lives. "As a grassroots youth-led movement, we know that the folks closest to the problem are often closest to the solution, and we know that that means that real, lasting change starts at the local level. When federal progress stalled, we made enormous progress at the state level-including in our home state of Florida. We're excited to fight for grassroots solutions by supporting this coalition alongside our friends in the gun safety movement to invest in and lift up state and local leaders as they work to solve the gun violence epidemic. From every corner of the country, these lawmakers prove that progress is possible when we put young people's lives and safety first."

"States are leading the way when it comes to implementing public health solutions to gun violence, building a sustainable public health and safety infrastructure, uplifting Black and Brown communities that are disproportionately impacted by gun violence, and advancing policies that address the root causes of violence," said Adzi Vokhiwa, Vice President of Policy at Community Justice. "This coalition will ensure that the state legislators across the country who are determined to stop gun violence in all forms can share best practices and learn from one another. Community Justice is honored to support these incredible leaders and applauds the creation of Legislators for Safer Communities."

Legislators for Safer Communities will serve as a hub for collaboration, partnership, shared resources, strategy, research, and peer networking. The coalition will work in partnership with Brady, Community Justice, Everytown, GIFFORDS, and March For Our Lives. Learn more about Legislators for Safer Communities at legislatorsforsafercommunities.org.

Co-Chairs:

* Senate Majority Whip Tizzy Lockman, Delaware

* Representative Christine Hunschofsky, Florida

* Representative Bob Morgan, Illinois

* Representative Keturah Herron, Kentucky

* Assembly Majority Floor Leader Sandra Jauregui, Nevada

* Representative Liz Berry, Washington

Steering Committee:

* Senator Loki Tobin, Alaska

* Assemblymember Jesse Gabriel, California

* Assemblymember Mike Gipson, California

* Senator Tom Sullivan, Colorado

* Senate Majority Whip Tizzy Lockman, Delaware

* Senate Majority Leader Bryan Townsend, Delaware

* Representative Christine Hunschofsky, Florida

* Representative Michelle Au, Georgia

* Representative Nabeela Syed, Illinois

* Representative Bob Morgan, Illinois

* Representative Keturah Herron, Kentucky

* Senator Royce Duplessis, Louisiana

* Speaker of the House Rachel Talbot Ross, Maine

* Senator Jeff Waldstreicher, Maryland

* House Majority Whip Ranjeev Puri, Michigan

* Representative Cedrick Frazier, Minnesota

* Assembly Majority Floor Leader Sandra Jauregui, Nevada

* Senator Debra Altschiller, New Hampshire

* Representative Andrea Romero, New Mexico

* Senator Zellnor Myrie, New York

* Speaker of the House Joanna McClinton, Pennsylvania

* Representative Justin J. Pearson, Tennessee

* Senator Roland Gutierrez, Texas

* Delegate Nadarius Clark, Virginia

* Delegate Cia Price, Virginia

* Representative Liz Berry, Washington

* Representative Deb Andraca, Wisconsin

* Representative Shelia Stubbs, Wisconsin

* * *

Original text here: https://www.bradyunited.org/about-us/press/legislators-for-safer-communities-guns

[Category: Political]

T40-MgEditor-8833777 T40-MgEditor

Copyright (c) 2024 Targeted News Service. All rights reserved.

- **Citation (apa Style)**
  Nation's Leading Gun Safety Organizations Applaud Creation of 'Legislators for Safer Communities'. (2024, September 17). *Targeted News Service (USA).* Available from NewsBank: Access World News – Historical and Current: https://infoweb.newsbank.com/apps/news/document-view?p=WORLDNEWS&docref=news/19BC49952F642808.